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Registration Cycles

All vehicle registrations expire according to schedules established by the Division. The 'initial registration' of a vehicle is defined as the first time the vehicle is subject to registration in Arizona. This is based on the Ownership Date entered in the Title and Registration tab in a Title service and creates the registration cycle; which is the Effective Date and Expiration Date (which is the beginning and end of the registration cycle).

► Example of Ownership Date

Ownership Date in Title Service

The Ownership Date helps determine the registration cycle, the fees, and expiration date calculated by MAX. In order to calculate the proper fees, the proper date needs to be entered.

- Out-of-state titles: **Use today's date**
- Arizona titles & MCOs: **Use date of sale**

Even though today's date or date of sale is entered as the Ownership Date, if permits were issued those dates may factor into the registration cycle. View the [Ownership Date & Month Portion](#) section for more information.

► Incorrect Ownership Date Entered for Out-of-State Titles

First Registered

The First Registered is based on when the vehicle is first registered in Arizona and consists of a month and year portion, which is partially based off of the Ownership Date. MAX determines the First Registered based off information (dates or permits) entered during the Title service. The First Registered date will not change, however, the registration cycle (Effective Date and Expiration Date) will change.

► Example of First Registered

Month Portion

The month portion of First Registered will be one month forward from the following (which ever is earliest):

- Purchase date
- Temporary Registration (TRP) issue date

- 90-Day Resident Registration issue date
- Date of application

Ownership Date & Month Portion

Out-of-State Titles: Ownership Date will be today's date, however, if there was a TRP or 90-Day Resident Registration, MAX will use their issue dates to determine the month portion, which would also affect the month portion of the Expiration Date.

MCOs & Arizona Titles: Ownership Date will be date of sale, unless any of the option listed above apply, then MAX will use those dates to determine the month portion, which would also affect the month portion of the Expiration Date.

Year Portion

- For new vehicles (MCOs) will be the current year, unless purchased in December, then it will be the next year
- For vehicles that are more than two years old, the year should be the model year of the vehicle
- For vehicles with an out-of-state title will be the model year of the vehicle



There is no policy that supports using the first registered information from an out-of-state title.

► Incorrect First Registered

Registration Effective Date

The vehicle's Effective Date is based on when the vehicle is first registered in Arizona. It is the beginning part of the registration cycle and consists of a month and year portion. MAX determines the Effective Date based off information (dates or permits) entered during the Title service.

The Effective Date and Expiration Date (registration cycle) will change when ownership is transferred to new owners.

Month Portion

Initially, the month portion is based on when the vehicle is first registered in Arizona and consists of a month and year portion.

Once ownership has transferred, the month portion will be based on when the vehicle was purchased.

Year Portion

The year portion will be the year of sale. Based on this year portion, the Expiration Date can be one, two, or five years from the year listed.

Registration Expiration Date

The vehicle's Expiration Date is the end of the registration cycle and consists of a month, day, and year portion. MAX determines the Registration Expiration based off information (dates or permits) entered during the Title service.

Month Portion

The month portion of the vehicle's expiration date will be the month of:

- Purchase date
- Temporary Registration (TRP) issue date
- 90-Day Resident Registration issue date
- Date of application

Day Portion

The day portion of the expiration is based on when in the month the vehicle is being registered:

- If the vehicle purchase date is the 1st through the 15th of the month, the expiration date will be the 15th day of the month
- If the vehicle purchase date is the 16th through the last day of the month, the expiration date will be the last day of the month
- If no permit was issued and there was a previous "Title Only", the expiration date will be the 15th or last day of the month of application

Year Portion

The year portion of the vehicle could be one, two, or five years from the year portion of the Effective Date, depending on vehicle or customer requirements.

Policy

8.9.2 Registration Cycles

HELPFUL LINKS

- » [MVD / DMV Public Website](#) »
- » [Customer Portal](#) »

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